



Richness of Culture

— Jillian Betke Bessette —

Let's face it, we're rich. As northerners we stand on a bounty of minerals beneath our very feet, as Manitobans and Saskatchewanians we're flush with the fresh faces of prosperity and opportunity... and as Canadians, well, we're just plain, old, filthy rich in every possible 'awe shucks' Canadian way.

Everything from our awe-inspiring natural beauty, to our world-renowned healthcare system, to the pure safety we enjoy each and every day make it obvious we have it good. (Of course, the rest of the world rightly agrees: Canada is currently ranked sixth on the United Nations' Human Development Index, which is a standard for measuring quality of life.)

But besides all those countable, material benefits, there is but one thing which, even though it is impossible to measure, is perhaps our most valuable asset - and that is our cultural richness. Every race, every nationality, every group of people has had a hand in defining Canada as we know it today - a diverse, vibrant, welcoming, nation who warmly greets and accepts everybody as they most wish to be accepted.

That sentiment is no more true in Toronto than it is in Thompson. And while we in the north may feel a world away from the hustle and bustle of hundreds of cultures and languages intermingling, it is only that here it's on a smaller scale. Although, according to Sukh Khokar, Executive Director of The Thompson Citizenship Council/ Multi Culture Centre, smaller is a relative term. Since its humble beginnings



Photo by Jillian Betke Bessette

Executive Director of the Multi Culture Centre, Sukh Khokar, stands with the newly revised Newcomers' Guide to Thompson.